One way to simulate the Smalltalk behavior in Rails is to not restart the Rails application on every test. A way to avoid restarting the Rails application is to have it already running in a background task and use the existing background application. Rails ships with the Spring gem, which does just that. Here's how to use Spring to speed up your tests.

## Installing Spring

Spring is a gem. It comes with Rails by default and you'll want it in your Gemfile. There are a couple of helper gems that you'll probably also want. All these gems go in the development group of the Gemfile:

```
gem "spring"
gem "spring-commands-rspec"
gem "spring-watcher-listen"
```

If you start a fresh Rails application with rails new, spring will already be there.

At this point you can see what all the fuss is about:

```
$ spring status
Spring is not running.
```

That was exciting. Let's try something else:

```
spring help
Version: 2.0.2

Usage: spring COMMAND [ARGS]

Commands for spring itself:

  binstub         Generate spring based binstubs.
                  Use --all to generate a binstub for all known commands.
                  Use --remove to revert.
  help            Print available commands.
  server          Explicitly start a Spring server in the foreground
  status          Show current status.
  stop            Stop all spring processes for this project.

Commands for your application:

  rails           Run a rails command.
                  The following sub commands will use spring:
                  l console, runner, generate, destroy, test.
  rake            Runs the rake command
  rspec           Runs the rspec command
```

The last command is there only because the spring-commands-rspec gem was added.